

## Question 15 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

**Analyse the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organisational performance.**

### Introduction

These three ideas form a chain, not three separate chapters. HRD philosophy is what leaders truly believe about people. HRD climate is what employees feel every day about trust, learning and fairness. Organisational performance is what the organisation achieves — goals, quality, service, profit, survival. Analysis must show how philosophy becomes climate, how climate becomes behaviour, and how behaviour becomes performance. It must also show the reverse: results can strengthen or destroy philosophy.

A beginner's mistake is to define the three terms and stop. The marks are for the relationship.

### Detailed points

- 1. HRD philosophy — the starting belief.** Philosophy means a belief that human beings have potential, that they deserve development, and that developing them is a duty of every manager, not a cost to cut whenever profits dip. It values people. If this belief is absent, the organisation may still copy appraisal forms from another company, but there is no inner commitment. Philosophy is invisible, but it decides which practices will be allowed to live.
- 2. Philosophy shapes HRD practices.** When leaders believe the philosophy, they release time for learning, they discuss development in reviews, they fund coaching, and they refuse to humiliate staff in public. When philosophy is only a sentence in the annual report, practices remain punitive: forced ranking, cancelled training, promotion by politics. So the first link is: philosophy → actual practices (appraisal style, training access, counselling quality).
- 3. Practices create HRD climate.** Employees do not read philosophy booklets. They experience their boss. Consistent developmental practices produce perceptions of openness, trust, autonomy and support — that is HRD climate. Inconsistent practices produce cynicism: 'they say people matter, they treat us as costs'. Climate is philosophy made into daily weather.
- 4. Climate shapes employee behaviour.** Supportive climate → people ask questions, admit gaps, help other departments, take initiative, apply training. Weak climate → fear, hiding mistakes, minimum work, knowledge hoarding. Behaviour is the bridge between 'how it feels' and 'what gets produced'.
- 5. Behaviour produces organisational performance.** Quality, productivity, customer satisfaction, innovation and adaptability are behavioural outcomes. A team that reports defects early saves cost. A team that hides defects creates warranty claims. Thus philosophy, through climate and behaviour, reaches performance. This is the forward chain the examiner wants.
- 6. Reverse loops — performance talks back.** If performance improves after sincere HRD, leaders say 'investment in people paid off' and philosophy becomes stronger. If performance is bad and leaders are impatient, they cut the HRD budget, climate worsens, behaviour worsens, performance falls further — a downward spiral. Analysis must mention this two-way relationship.
- 7. The dangerous case: high philosophy, weak climate.** The worst relationship is inconsistency. Posters say 'learning organisation' while bosses shout. Trust falls more than if nothing had been promised, because employees feel cheated. Performance then suffers from cynicism, which is harder to repair than simple skill shortage.
- 8. Implication of the analysis.** To raise performance, do not start with a slogan or only with a target. Start with philosophy that leaders will actually live, then design practices, then measure climate, then look at results. Measuring only last quarter's numbers and ignoring climate misleads management. The three must be managed as one system.

**Conclusion.** Write the chain: HRD philosophy → practices → HRD climate → employee behaviour → organisational performance, with feedback from results to philosophy. Warn that slogans without climate destroy

*trust and performance. That relationship is the heart of the answer.*